

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: Sally interviews a local treasure. Learn about his family and his past.



Learning Outcome

Describe past experiences in a range of social and work contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can write about family life.
- I can write experiences I've had or haven't had.
- I can write about past habits.

Ask your partner:

- Do you have family members who are over 80 years old?
- Do you ask them about their past experiences?
- What do you think you can learn from the elderly?





Let's Explore!

Listen to Sally **engage*** Mr. Sims in a stimulating interview.

* To get and keep someone's attention.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Sally:** Thank you for letting me chat with you for *Cambridge Life* magazine. I haven't had the opportunity to meet a gentleman of your age. You would have seen a lot.
- Tom:** I have seen a lot in my 100 years.
- Sally:** I heard that you were in the Second World War.
- Tom:** Yes, I was only 18 when I had to leave my family. I was part of the Western Front, you know.
- Sally:** You were very brave. How long were you there?
- Tom:** Six months. The stress of combat was overwhelming, so I started smoking. Thank goodness I quit the nasty habit 30 years ago. I used to smoke a pack a day.
- Sally:** When did you return home?
- Tom:** In 1945. I married my childhood sweetheart, Anne. Our twin boys, Robert and James, were born a couple years later. We later adopted Samuel, Grace and Albert.
- Sally:** You have a large family!
- Tom:** Yes, they are now grown with families of their own.
- Sally:** You must eat well and exercise. What's your secret?
- Tom:** I haven't had much illness in my later years. I believe in fresh air, a daily walk and a nice glass of port before bedtime.
- Sally:** You've had some interesting experiences in your life.





Let's Practice!

Let's talk about family life.

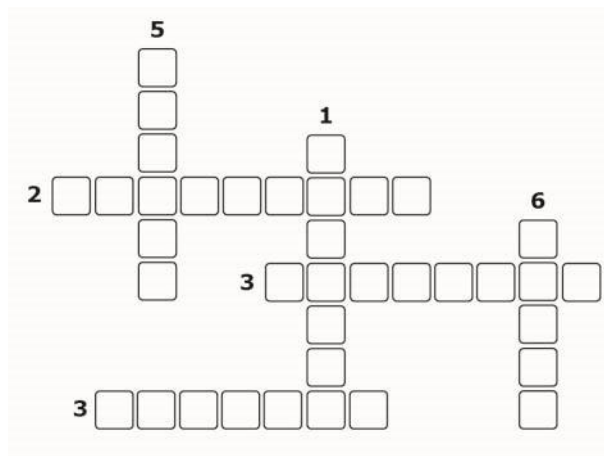
Instructions: Read the dialogue on page 2 again. Then read the clues and complete the crossword.

DOWN

1. I was only eighteen when I had _____ my family.
5. You have a large _____!
6. Yes, they are now _____ with families of their own.

ACROSS

2. I married my _____ sweetheart, Anne.
3. Our twin boys, Robert and James, _____ a couple years later.
4. We later _____ Samuel, Grace and Albert.



Let's Practice!

Sally wants to interview you for *Cambridge Life*! Can you answer a few questions?

Instructions: Read the dialogue again and review the examples. Complete the interview with Sally. Write about what you have had and haven't had. Write about past habits. Ask your teacher to revise your interview.





Extension Activity

It is time to interview a friend of the family.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- You are a reporter for *Cambridge Life*. You have to interview a friend of the family about their life.
- Ask 6-8 questions.
- Ask about their family, past habits and if they had or haven't had an interesting life.
- Write down their answers in complete sentences.

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I interview a family member.

☐ ☐

I ask questions about family and past experiences.

☐ ☐

I write sentences about the life of others.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **Western Front** (noun): A name used to describe where militaries met in the World Wars.
e.g. I was part of the Western Front in 1943.
- **combat** (noun): active fighting
e.g. The stress of combat was overwhelming, so I started smoking.
- **nasty** (adjective): very unpleasant to see, smell, taste, etc.
e.g. Smoking is a nasty habit.
- **port** (noun): a strong, sweet, usually dark red wine that is made in Portugal
e.g. I always have a glass of port before bed.
- **to adopt** (verb): to take a child of other parents legally as your own child
e.g. I adopted three children.





Learning Points

Writing an Autobiography

To write an autobiography you need to follow the next steps:

1. Write your name and personal information. (date and place of birth)
2. Write about your family life.
3. Write about some of the activities you usually like to do.
4. Write about your most exciting experiences and challenges.
5. Write about things you haven't done that you want to do in the future.

Example:

My Autobiography

My name is Claire Feeney. I was born in Seattle in 1993. I studied in a nice and quiet school. I live in Seattle with my parents, my siblings and my grandmother. I also have a huge black dog. I love outdoors sports, I usually go hiking to Mount Rainier and sometimes I play baseball with my friends. I also love to travel. I have travelled to Turkey, Peru and Nigeria. I have eaten typical food from all those countries. I haven't visited Colombia yet but I would love to visit my penpal in Bogotá some day because I haven't seen her in years.

Used to and Would for Past Habits

Would and *used to* have similar meanings. They are both used to describe something that happened regularly in the past but doesn't happen any longer.

However, there is an important difference between *used to* and *would*. *Would* is not used unless you know that the time frame is in the past, while *used to* does not require this.

Examples:

- *I used to smoke a pack of cigarettes a day.*
- *I used to eat unhealthy food.*
- *I would often go to bed after midnight.*

